Board 1
West Deals
None Vul

♠ A K 10 9 4
♥ 8 5 3
♦ 6 5 3
♣ K 9

♠ 7 5 3
♥ A K Q 10 6
♦ J 10 2
♣ Q J

♠ 2
♥ J 9 4 2
♦ 9 8 7
♣ A 10 7 5 4

♠ Q J 8 6
♥ 7
♦ A K Q 4
♣ 8 6 3 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♥	1♠	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♥4

You have 14 points in support of ♠s; however, partner's overcall does not promise more than 9 points or so.

So you cue-bid 2♥, showing a good hand with support and forcing partner to bid again. Partner bids 3♠.

4♠. Partner's jump shows a good overcall, but not enough strength to insist on game when you might have only 11 points. You have plenty extra so you bid the game.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 3
♥ 7 6 2
♦ 9 7 3
♣ 10 9 8 7 3 2

♠ J 10 9 8
♥ J 9 4
♦ A 8 6 2
♣ A J

♠ A K Q 6 4 2
♥ 8
♦ K Q 4
♣ K Q 5

♠ 7 5
♥ A K Q 10 5 3
♦ J 10 5
♣ 6 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♠	2♥
3♥	Pass	4NT[1]	Pass
5♥[2]	Pass	6♠	
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♠ by East
Lead: ♥K

Partner has a limit raise or better in ♠s, 11 points or more.

There is only one thing you want to know now - how many Aces partner holds. So you bid 4NT to find out. Partner responds 5♥.

You know you have a loser. Bid 6♠.

Board 3
East Deals
E-W Vul

♠ 8 6
♥ A 9 8 4
♦ 9 6 5 4
♣ A Q J

♠ K 9 5 3 2
♥ 6
♦ K Q 10 2
♣ 8 6 2

♠ A 10
♥ 7 5 3
♦ A J
♣ K 9 7 5 4 3

♠ Q J 7 4
♥ K Q J 10 2
♦ 8 7 3
♣ 10

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♣	1♥
1♠	2♣	Pass	2♥
All Pass			

2♥ by South
Lead: ♣2

You have 12 points in support of ♥s; however, partner's overcall does not promise more than 9 points or so.

So you cue-bid 2♣. Since the opponents have bid two suits you can cue-bid either one of them, so you usually pick the one you have the most strength in. Partner bids 2♥.

Pass. Partner had a minimum overcall so he made a minimum rebid.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

♠ J 8 5 2
♥ 2
♦ 8
♣ A K Q J 8 6 5

♠ A 7 3
♥ A K 8 5 3
♦ A 6
♣ 9 7 4

♠ K Q 10 6
♥ Q J 9 7 6
♦ Q J 7 5
♣ —

♠ 9 4
♥ 10 4
♦ K 10 9 4 3 2
♣ 10 3 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♥	2♣	3♣	Pass
4♥	Pass	5♣	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			

6♥ by West
Lead: ♣K

You have about 15 points in support of ♥s so you cue-bid 3♣, showing a limit raise or better and forcing partner to bid again. Partner bids 4♥.

5♣. Partner's jump shows a good hand and you have more than you have promised so far. This cue-bid is a different type, showing first round control in ♣s, Ace or void. That was apparently what partner wanted to hear since he went right to slam.